

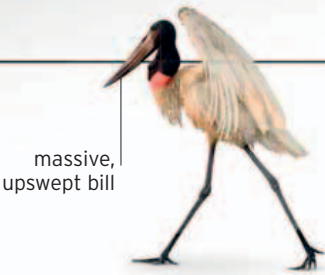


▷ **HEAD FIRST**
The giant otter's diet consists mainly of fish, including characins, which are related to piranhas and catfish. They also eat frogs, snakes, and turtles.



Jabiru stork

Jabiru mycteria



massive, upswept bill

One of South America's largest birds, the male jabiru has a massive bill, measuring 12–14 in (30–35 cm). Social waterside birds, jabirus use their bill to detect underwater prey just like a spoonbill, sweeping it sideways, partly open. The male's naked black neck inflates in courtship and aggressive displays, giving the bird its name, which means

"swollen neck" in the local Tupi-Guarani language. Nests are huge structures of sticks, constructed in busy, mixed colonies of waterbirds and used for several years. Two to five eggs are laid, and the young fly when 15 weeks old. They need parental care for three more months, so most pairs nest every other year. Jabirus may live for more than 35 years.

↔ 4–5 ft (1.2–1.5 m)

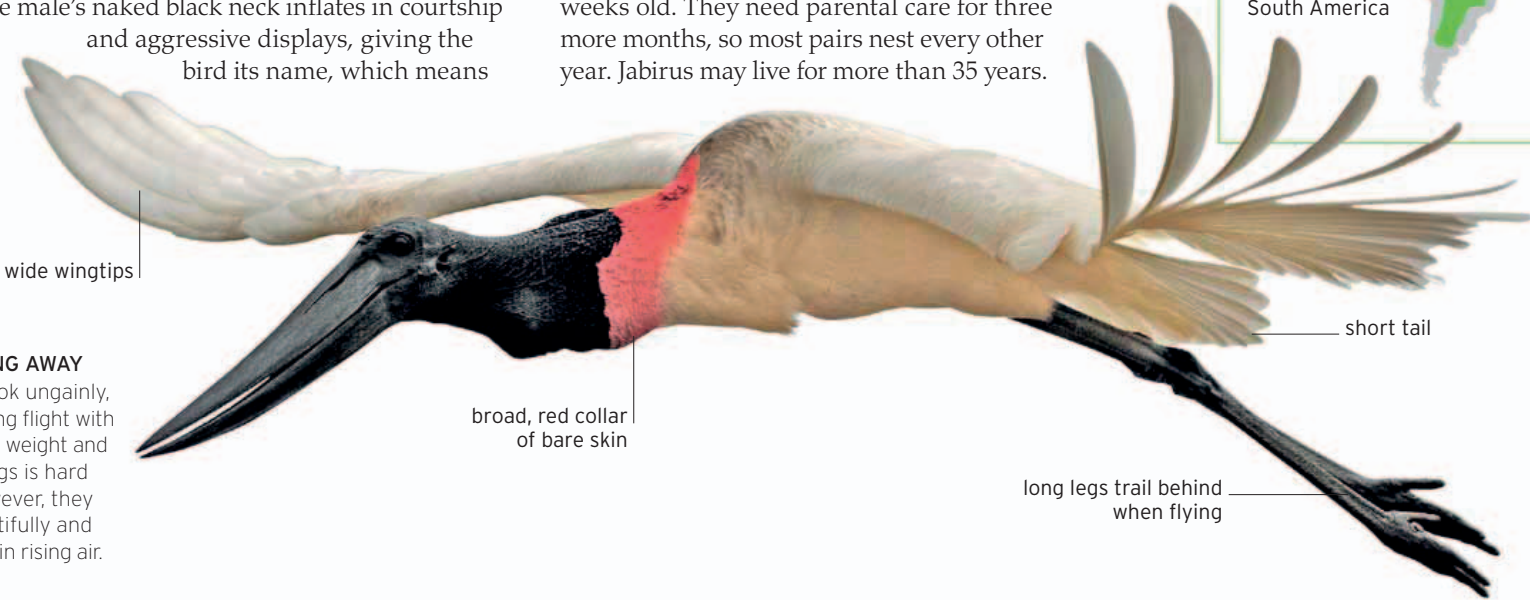
⚖ 11–15 lb (5–7 kg)

⊗ Common

🐟 Fish, amphibians, reptiles

🏠

Central and South America



wide wingtips

broad, red collar of bare skin

short tail

long legs trail behind when flying

▷ **SOARING AWAY**
Jabirus look ungainly, and flapping flight with such great weight and broad wings is hard work. However, they soar beautifully and efficiently in rising air.